Lab 09: Midnight Commander

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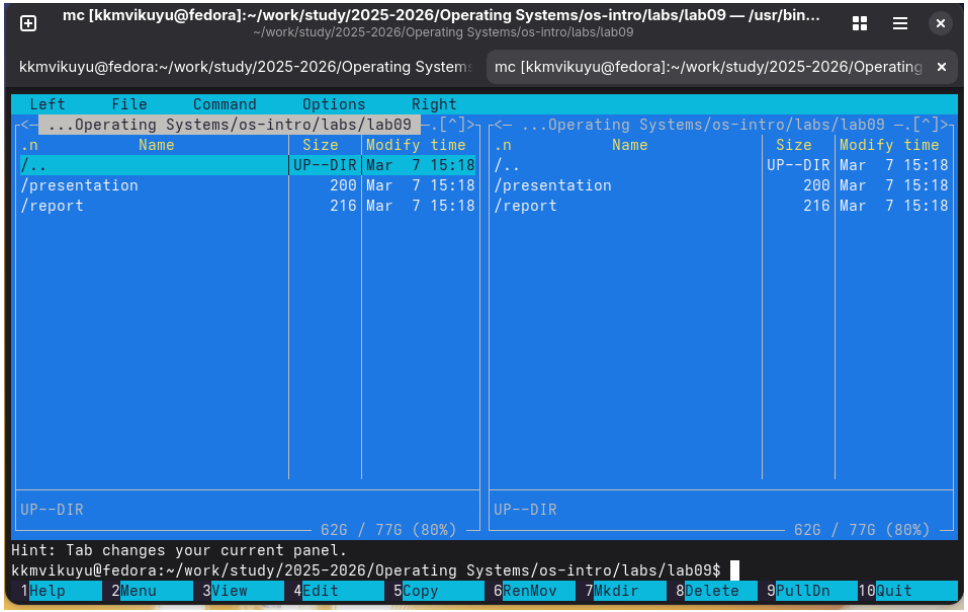
What is Midnight Commander?

- File manager for Linux/Unix terminal
- Two-panel interface
- Mouse and keyboard support
- Built-in editor with syntax highlighting

Launch: `mc`

Main Interface

- Left panel - current directory
- Right panel - another directory
- F1-F10 at bottom
- Menu bar (F9)



Main mc window

Function Keys

Key	Action
F1	Help
F3	View file
F4	Edit file
F5	Copy
F6	Move/Rename
F7	Create directory
F8	Delete
F9	Menu
F10	Exit

Panel Modes

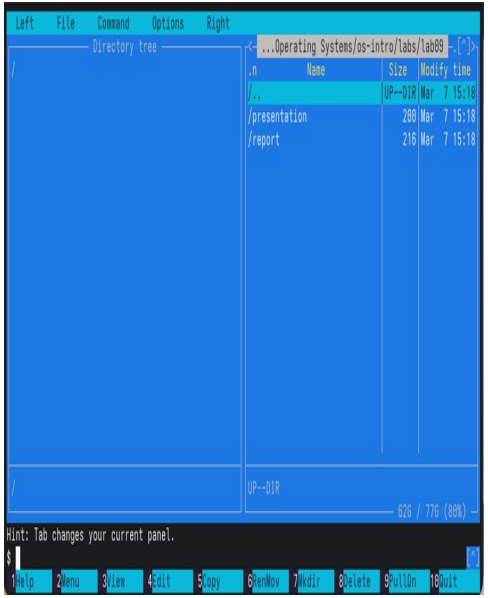
Information Mode (F9 → Left → Info)

Shows: file size, permissions, owner, filesystem info

Tree Mode (F9 → Left → Tree)

Shows directory tree structure

Tree mode

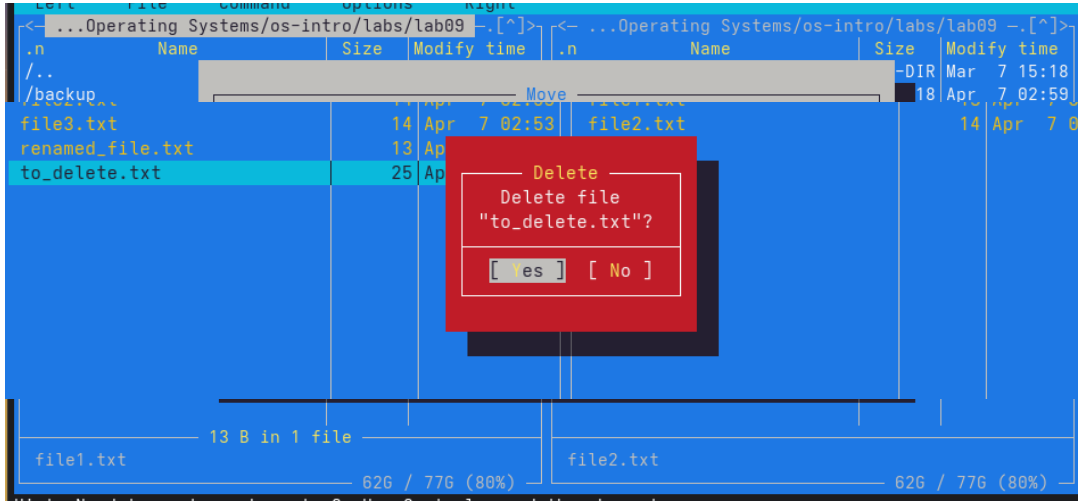


Info mode

Delete (F8) - Delete with confirmation

File Operations

Delete (F8) - Delete files

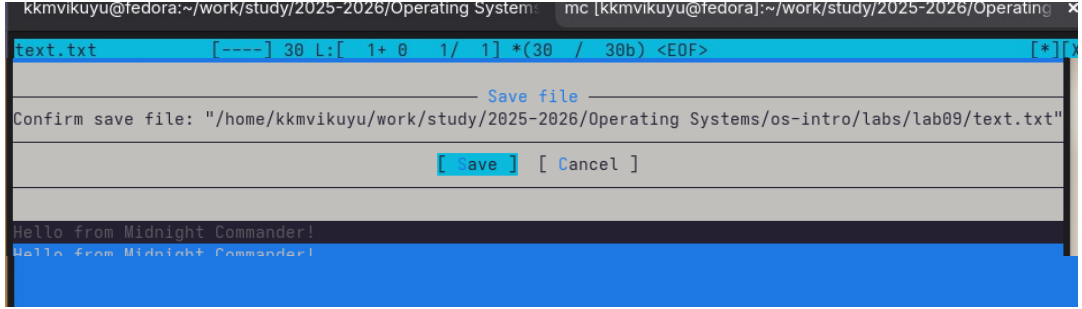


Delete dialog

Creating Directories & Files

Create directory (F7)

Save (F2) - Save file

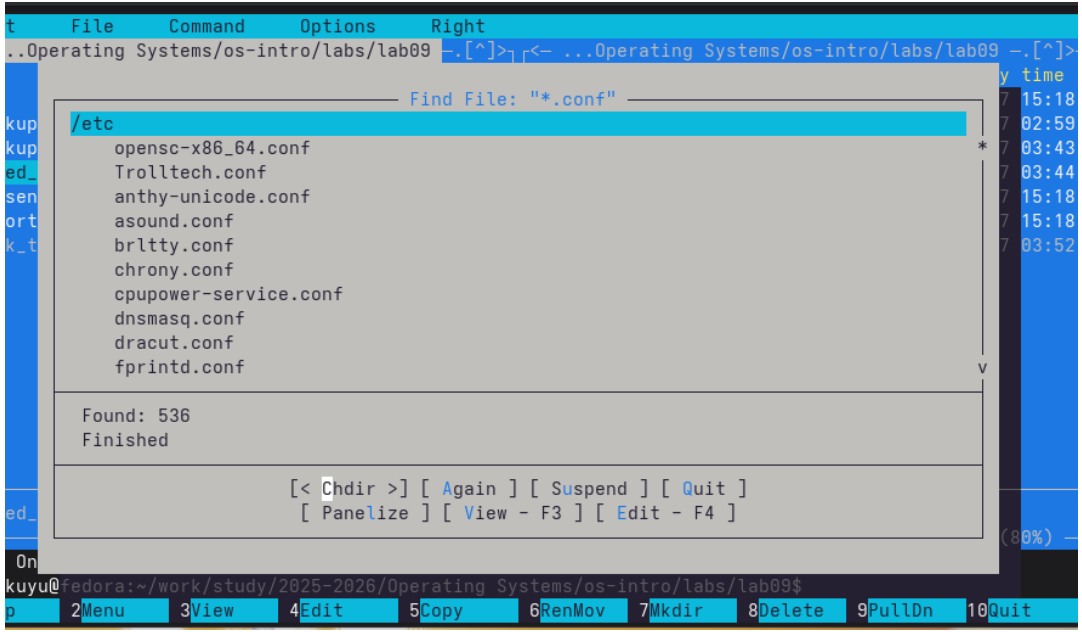


Save dialog

Search by: name pattern, content, location

Search for Files

F9 → Command → Find file

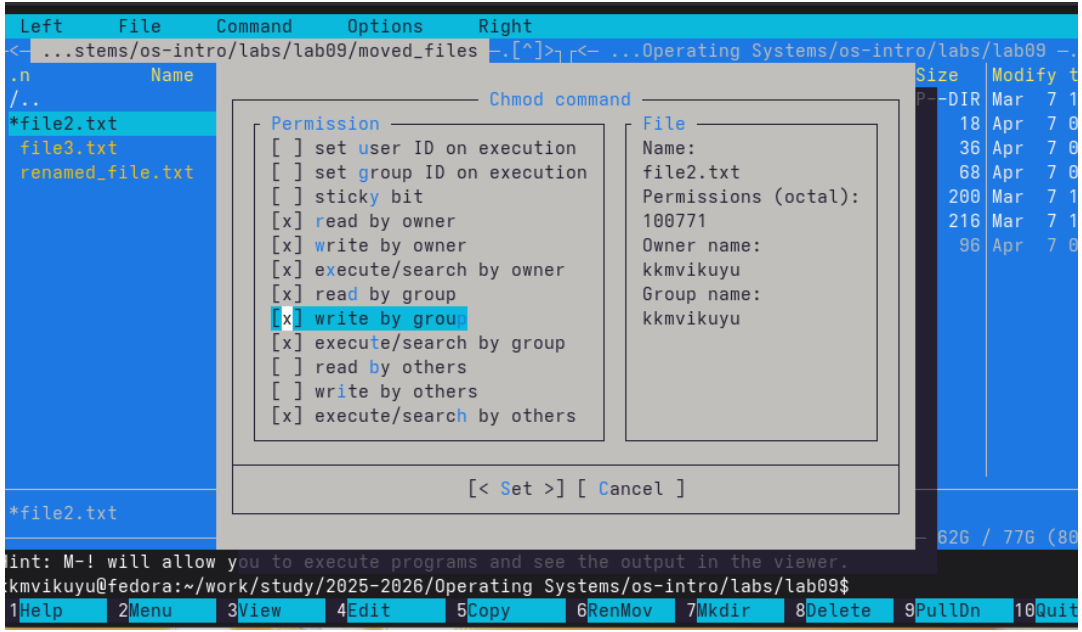


Search results

Change Permissions (Chmod)

F9 → File → Chmod

- Checkboxes for r/w/x
- Octal notation (e.g., 755)
- Owner/Group/Others



Chmod dialog

Built-in Editor Navigation

Key	Action
`Ctrl + Home`	Go to beginning
`Ctrl + End`	Go to end
`Ctrl + y`	Delete line
`Ctrl + u`	Undo
`F2`	Save
`F10`	Exit

Toggle: F9 → Options → Syntax highlighting

Syntax Highlighting

Python file - Automatic highlighting

Python syntax

Syntax toggle

Summary

Commands learned: - `mc` - launch - F3/F4/F5/F6/F7/F8 - file operations - F9 - menu access - Ctrl+Home/End - editor navigation

Skills gained: - Two-panel file management - Built-in editor with syntax highlighting - File search and permissions

Thank You!

Questions?

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